Nastasia Klevak

Stanford CA, USA nklevak@stanford.edu nastasia-klevak nklevak

Education

Stanford University, PhD in Psychology (Cognitive Neuroscience) – Stanford CA, USA Sept 2023 – present
- Researches the relationship between learning, effort, and cognitive fatigue and its neural underpinnings
- Utilizes brain imaging (fMRI), large-scale data analysis, computational modeling, machine learning methods, and behavioral experiment design
- Mind, Brain, Computation and Technology fellow

Princeton University, BSE in Computer Science – Princeton NJ, USA Sept 2018 – May 2022
- Overall GPA: 3.7/4.0 (Departmental GPA: 3.9/4.0)
- Certificates in Cognitive Science and Linguistics
- Graduated Cum Laude and with Honors

Experience

Full-time Research Assistant and Lab Manager, Princeton Neuroscience Institute – Princeton NJ, USA Aug 2022 – Aug 2023
- Built supervised learning models to classify high-dimensional fMRI data from the orbitofrontal cortex for real-time cognitive state detection
- Led end-to-end data collection and preprocessing workflows for neuroimaging experiments

Software Engineer Intern, Meta, FAIR Labs – Seattle WA, USA May 2021 – Aug 2021
- Worked on an end-to-end video processing pipeline using Python to identify and optimize computational bottlenecks
- Improved video processing speed by 10× through algorithm optimization and efficient data processing

Director, Ignite Stem – Princeton NJ, USA June 2020 – May 2021
- Managed a team of 24 students to host events and develop ed-tech content for K–12 STEM educators and students
- Organized the first Ignite Stem Design Challenge for 300 participants focused on applying Design Thinking to real-world problems
- Led the content team for 1.5 years to curate and develop educational technology materials

Software Engineer Intern, Meta – Boston MA, USA May 2020 – Aug 2020
- Developed and enhanced live location sharing features on Facebook web within the Location Products team
- Utilized React, PHP, Reason, CSS, HTML, JS, and Hack for web development

Publications

Estimating the replicability of psychology experiments after an initial failure to replicate Aug 2025

Veronica Boyce, Ben Prystawski, … **Nastasia Klevak**, … Michael C. Frank

`https://doi.org/10.1525/collabra.125685`

Conference Presentations and Abstracts

Self-paced rest decisions: stable but ineffective for recovery Aug 2026
Extended abstract and poster, CCN 2026
Nastasia Klevak, Joshua W. Buckholtz, Russell A. Poldrack

Toward a neural taxonomy of cognitive control: A dense-sampling study of 46 individuals June 2026
Poster, OHBM 2026
Patrick G. Bissett, … **Nastasia Klevak**, … Russell A. Poldrack

Atypical Event Segmentation in Schizotypy June 2026
Poster, SOBP 2026
William N. Koller, … **Nastasia Klevak**, … Kenneth A. Norman, Yael Niv

The effect of task switching on cognitive fatigue Aug 2025
Extended abstract and poster, CCN 2025
Nastasia Klevak, Joshua W. Buckholtz, Russell A. Poldrack

`https://2025.ccneuro.org/.../Klevak_2025_task_switching_cognitive_fatigue.pdf`

Skills

Programming: Python (NumPy, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch), Java, C, Git, Web development (React, HTML, CSS, JS)

Research: fMRI and online behavioral experiment design, large-scale data analysis, machine learning, computational modeling (Bayesian, Markov, and mixed effects models)

Languages: English (Native), Russian (Fluent)